India', which included parts of modern-day Arunachal Pradesh, Ladakh, Darjeeling, Sikkim and Bhutan. [6]

Hence, in early February 1948, the Government of India had considered it necessary to make it clear to the Nationalist Chinese Ambassador in Delhi, that the previous treaties remained in force and that India regarded itself as having replaced Great Britain in regard to all treaty rights and obligations that previously existed between Great Britain and Tibet. [7] Nonetheless, there was unease in India over the refusal of the Chinese government to accept the McMahon Line, and this question became more acute when a Communist victory in China became a distinct possibility. Yet, unlike Mao, Nehru did not have a negative image of China. In fact, he regarded a revitalized China as essential for Asian resurgence, and as a partner of India.

Thus, in early 1950, both China and India had clear objectives in Tibet. China's was to seize Tibet, to extinguish its autonomy and to legitimize the People's Republic of China's absolute control over Tibet. India's objective was to preserve the status quo to the maximum possible extent and to legitimize its boundary with Tibet. The two countries adopted very different strategies in the pursuit of their objectives. A description of facts is required in order to understand the manner in which both pursued their objectives, the strategies that each adopted and their outcomes.

China's strategy was to deal with the Tibet issue in a step-by-step fashion. Its immediate priority was to secure the physical possession of Tibetan territory, for which it had already set the wheels in motion in January 1950. In order to achieve this objective, they pursued two strategies—to deter collusion between America and India, and to prevent Indian assistance to the Tibetan government. Tactics were decided accordingly. They adopted a soft and conciliatory approach while they